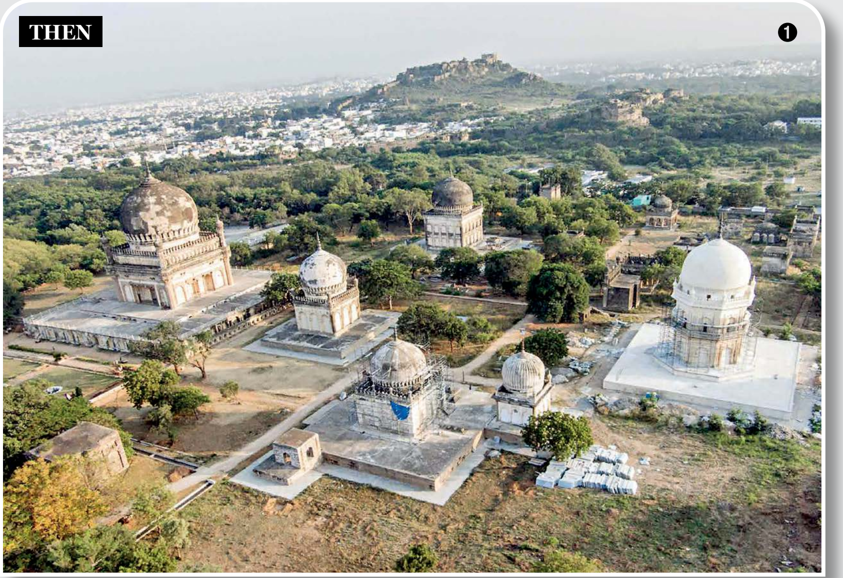
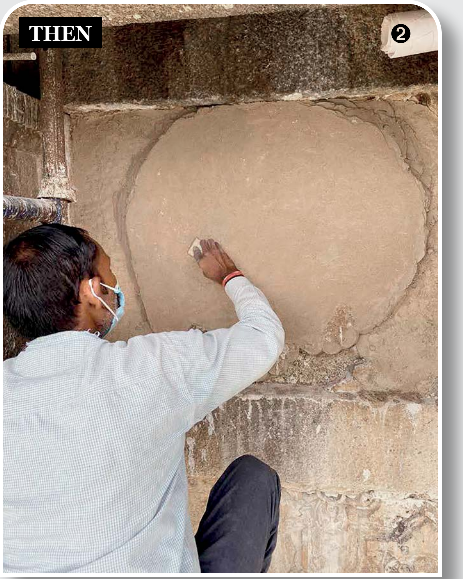
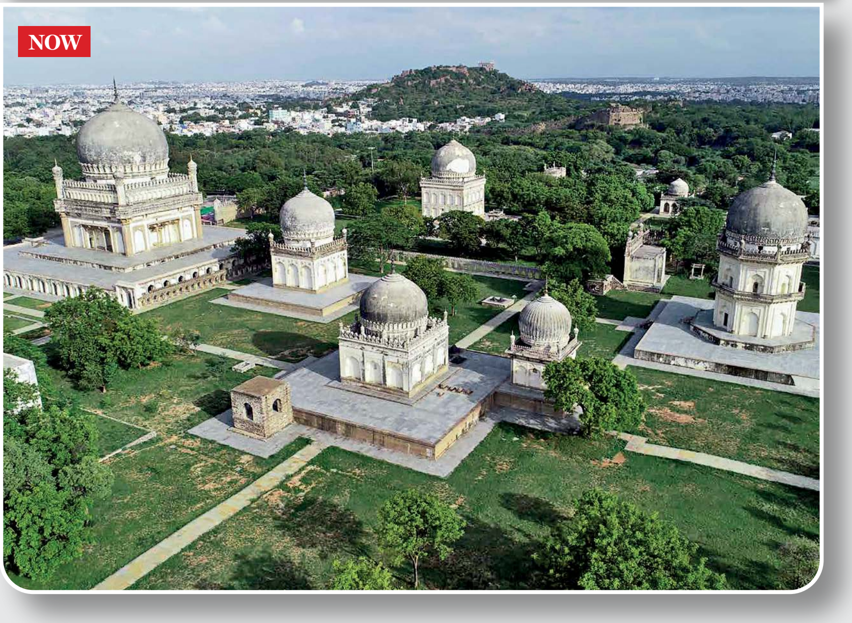
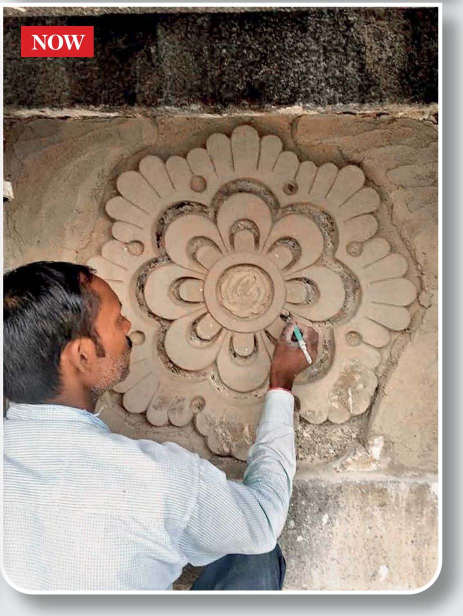
The Toil Behind the Glory









refurbished Qutb Shahi Heritage Park (QSHP) to Telangana chief minister A. Revanth Reddy on July 28. The AKTC was established by Karim Aga Khan to promote and preserve the diverse cultural heritage of Muslim societies.

At a glance, the glistening, globular domes of the QSHP mausoleums are testament to the outstanding work of the AKTC—the legacy of the founders of Hyderabad, the Quli Qutb Shah line of kings are now restored to their pristine glory. Interspersed among the majestic royal mausoleums and gardens such as those of Sultan Quli Qutb Shah and Mohammad Quli Qutb Shah are traces of old settlements, aquaducts and about 200 gravestones, many of them intricately ornamented. Coupled with this is the creation of ecological buffer zones planted with over 12,000 native trees in an area known for rampant encroachments that have already marred the precincts of the Golconda Fort.

WITH AROUND 100 MONUMENTS AND STRUCTURES RESTORED AND 106 ACRES LANDSCAPED, QSHP HAS BEEN INDIA'S LARGEST CONSERVATION PROJECT